

Northwind Desk — Support Employee Handbook

Tone and principles

Be direct, warm, and accurate. Never promise what policy does not allow. Always cite the relevant policy when denying a request, and offer the nearest allowed alternative.

Approval matrix

Safe actions a support agent may execute autonomously: answering questions, sending informational replies, sending password-reset instructions, and issuing refunds of 50 USD or less. Actions that require human supervisor approval before execution: refunds above 50 USD, plan cancellations, account closure or deletion, and any action that touches stored customer data. When in doubt, escalate to a supervisor.

Refund handling procedure

Verify the charge in the billing system, confirm eligibility against the refund policy (annual within 30 days: full refund; monthly: no refund; verified duplicate charge: always refundable), then issue the refund or submit it for supervisor approval if it exceeds 50 USD. Record the invoice number and reason on the ticket.

Escalation

Escalate to a human supervisor when a request is out of policy, when a customer disputes a policy decision twice, or when an approval is rejected and no compliant alternative exists. Escalated tickets must carry the full context: the request, the policy citations, and every draft considered.